Score

Connor Simpson

Tuba Quartet (ETTT) and live electronics

Scordatura

4'10"

2021

For Perusal Only

Mere Fly Press

Scordatura
Tuba Quartet (ETTT) and live electronics
2022
4 minutes and 10 seconds
Connor Simpson
Mere Fly Press (ASCAP)

Program Notes

Scordatura creates a microtonal soundscape through the detuning of the ensemble's valves. The work explores the physical phenomena of beating as well as harmonies found in just intonation and 24 tone equal temperament. Each tubist uses live electronics to provide themselves with tuning pitches throughout the work.

Performance Notes

The work may be performed with more than four tubas but must be performed with an equal number of euphoniums, F tubas, C tubas, and Bb tubas. Live electronics are to be used by the performers to assist in tuning. Each performer will need a laptop installed with Pure Data and headphones.

Pure Data

To download Pure Data performers must access the website https://puredata.info/downloads and install the newest Vanilla copy of Pure Data based on their computers operating system. Each performer must then also download a copy of the Pure Data patch specific to their part available at the request of the composer at csimpsoncomposer@gmail.com.

Tuning

Each performer is to tune their fourth valve down a quarter tone and tune the rest of their valves in accordance with 12 tone equal temperament. Please tune to the pitches specified below.

Euphonium -Tune the main slide precisely to Bb3 or 233.08Hz
-Tune the 2nd valve slide precisely to A3 or 220.00Hz
-Tune the 1st valve slide precisely to Ab3 or 207.65Hz
-Tune the 3rd valve to precisely G3 or 196.00Hz
-Tune the 4th valve to F3 -50cents or 169.64Hz

F Tuba -Tune the main slide precisely to F3 or 174.61Hz
-Tune the 2nd valve slide precisely to E3 or 164.81Hz
-Tune the 1st valve slide precisely to Eb3 or 155.56Hz
-Tune the 3rd valve to precisely D3 or 146.83Hz
-Tune the 4th valve to C3 -50cents or 127.09Hz

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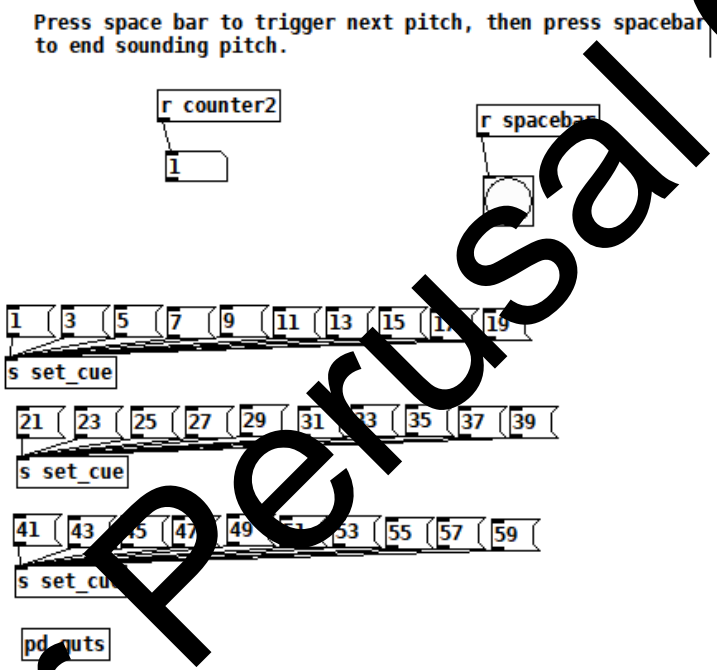
C Tuba -Tune the main slide precisely to C4 or 261.63Hz
-Tune the 2nd valve slide precisely to B3 or 246.94Hz
-Tune the 1st valve slide precisely to Bb3 or 233.08Hz
-Tune the 3rd valve to precisely A3 or 220.00Hz
-Tune the 4th valve to G3 -50cents or 190.42

Bb Tuba - Tune the main slide precisely to Bb3 or 233.08Hz
-Tune the 2nd valve slide precisely to A3 or 220.00Hz
-Tune the 1st valve slide precisely to Ab3 or 207.65Hz
-Tune the 3rd valve to precisely G3 or 196.00Hz
-Tune the 4th valve to F3 -50cents or 169.64Hz

Navigating the Patch

Each Performer's patch will appear as below.



The patch is used to provide the performer with tuning pitches throughout the work. The spacebar, a foot pedal, or a page-turning pedal may be used to proceed through the patch. The counter box in the upper left side indicates the next electronic cue to be executed. Odd numbers indicate a pitch will be sounded, whereas even numbers cut off the sounding pitch. The circle in the upper right indicates that the patch is receiving input from the spacebar, foot pedal etc. The list of numbers in the lower section of the patch may be clicked to skip to directly that cue. The backspace key may also be used to skip back to the beginning of the piece. Please do not hesitate to contact me at csimpsoncomposer@gmail.com regarding any questions about the patch or piece.

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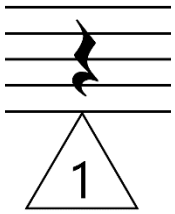
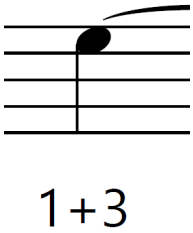
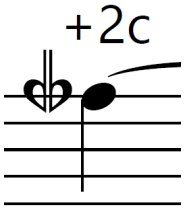
The Score



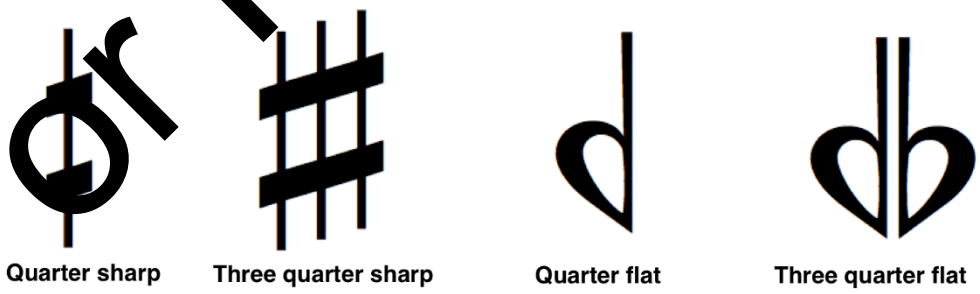
Triangular cue markings indicate approximately when to trigger the next cue. Precise rhythm of cues is not important and may be left to the discretion of the performer.



Fingerings are provided below every pitch within the piece. This fingering is to be used in order to achieve optimal intonation and tone for the desired frequency.



The notated pitches of the work are rounded to their nearest 24 tone equal temperament neighbor and offset from that pitch is given in cents above the note. The accidentals used for quartertones are shown below.



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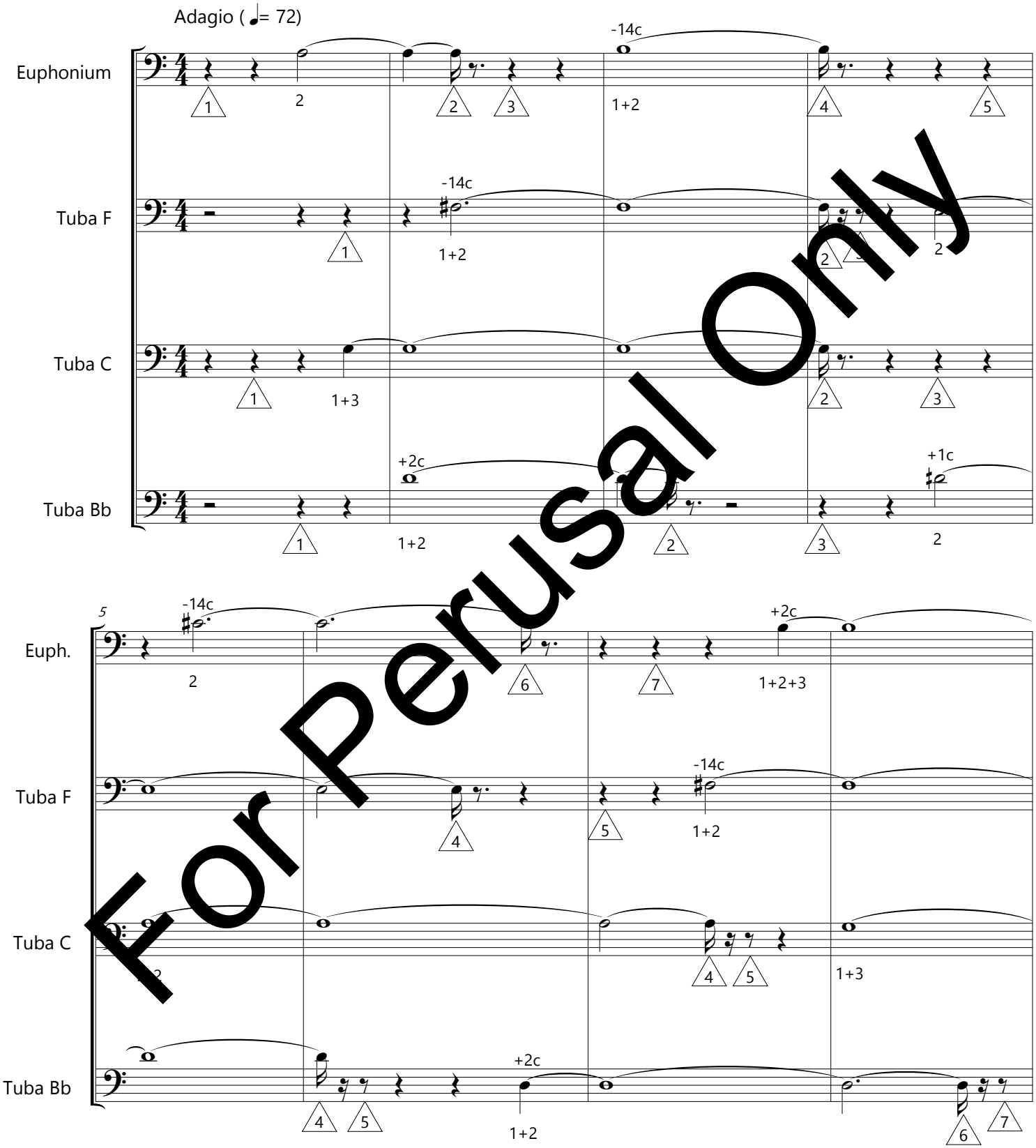

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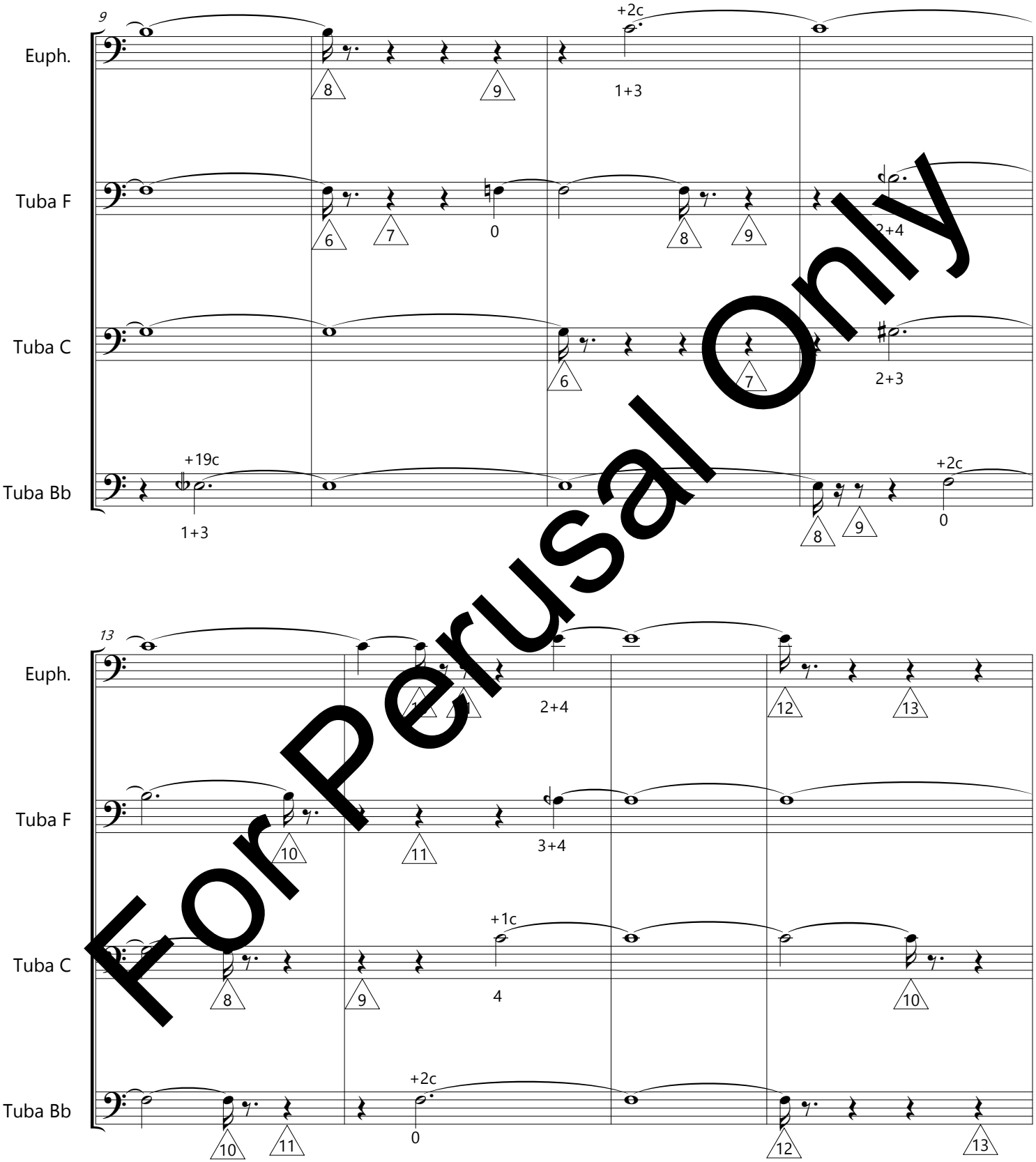

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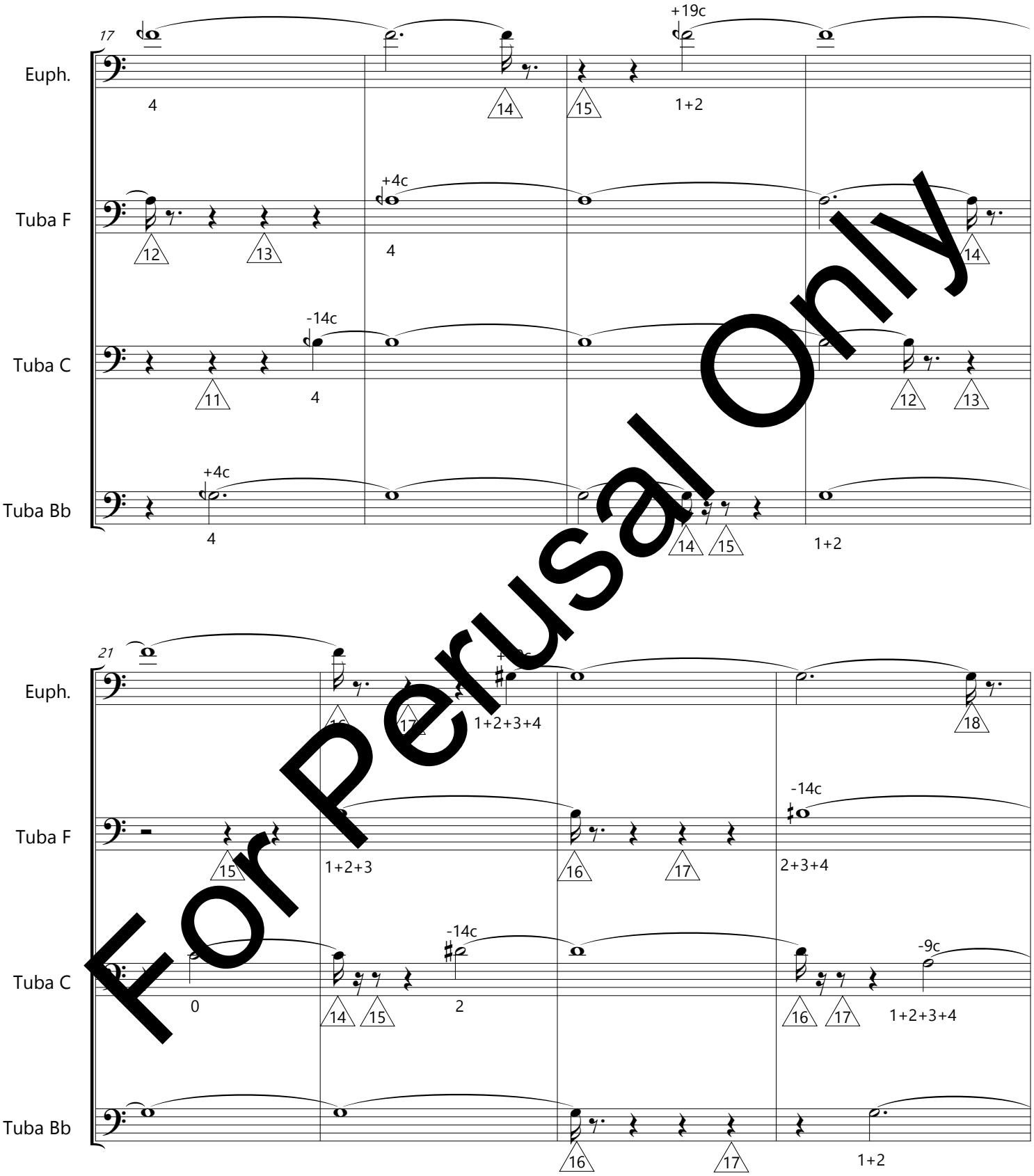

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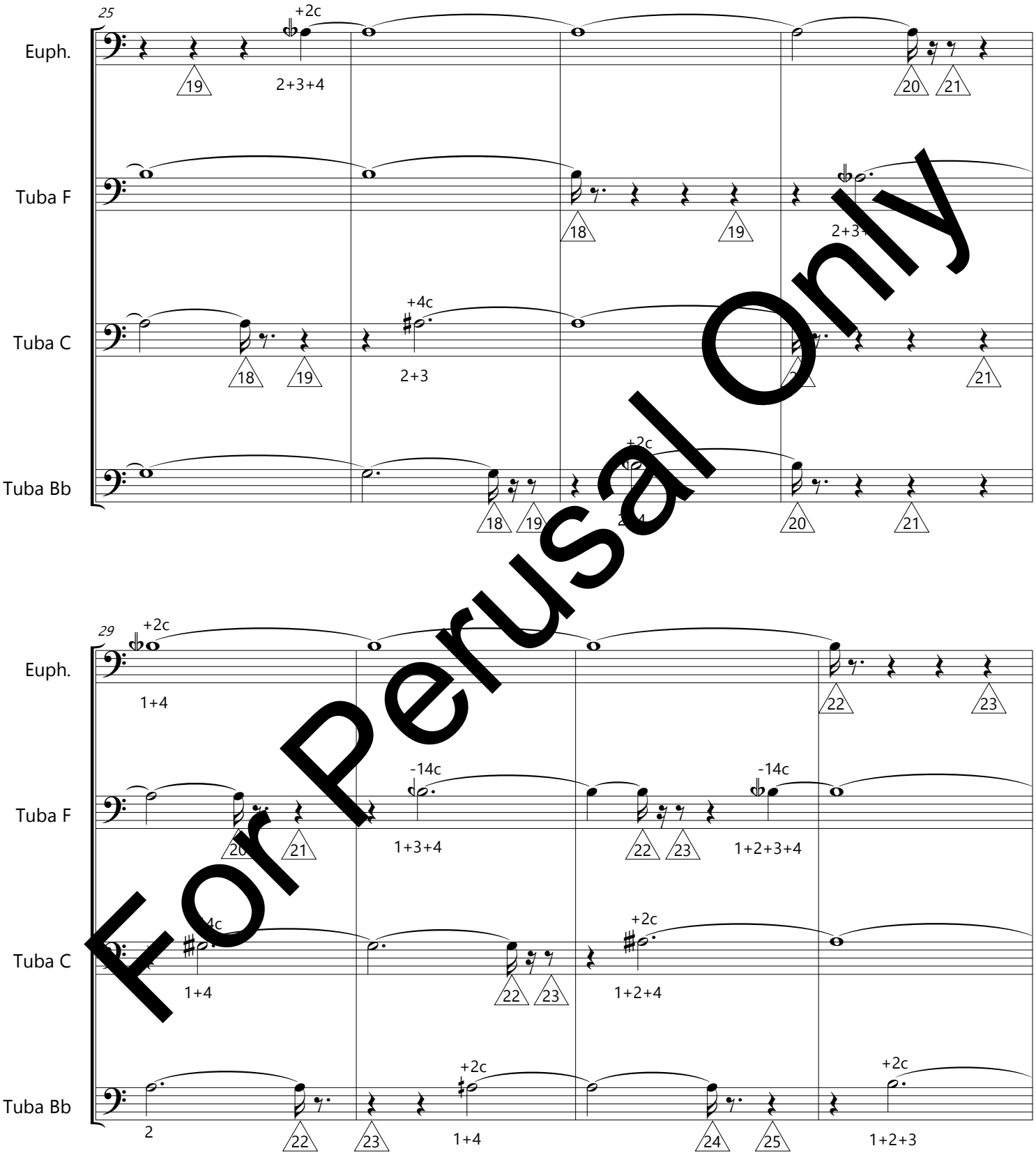

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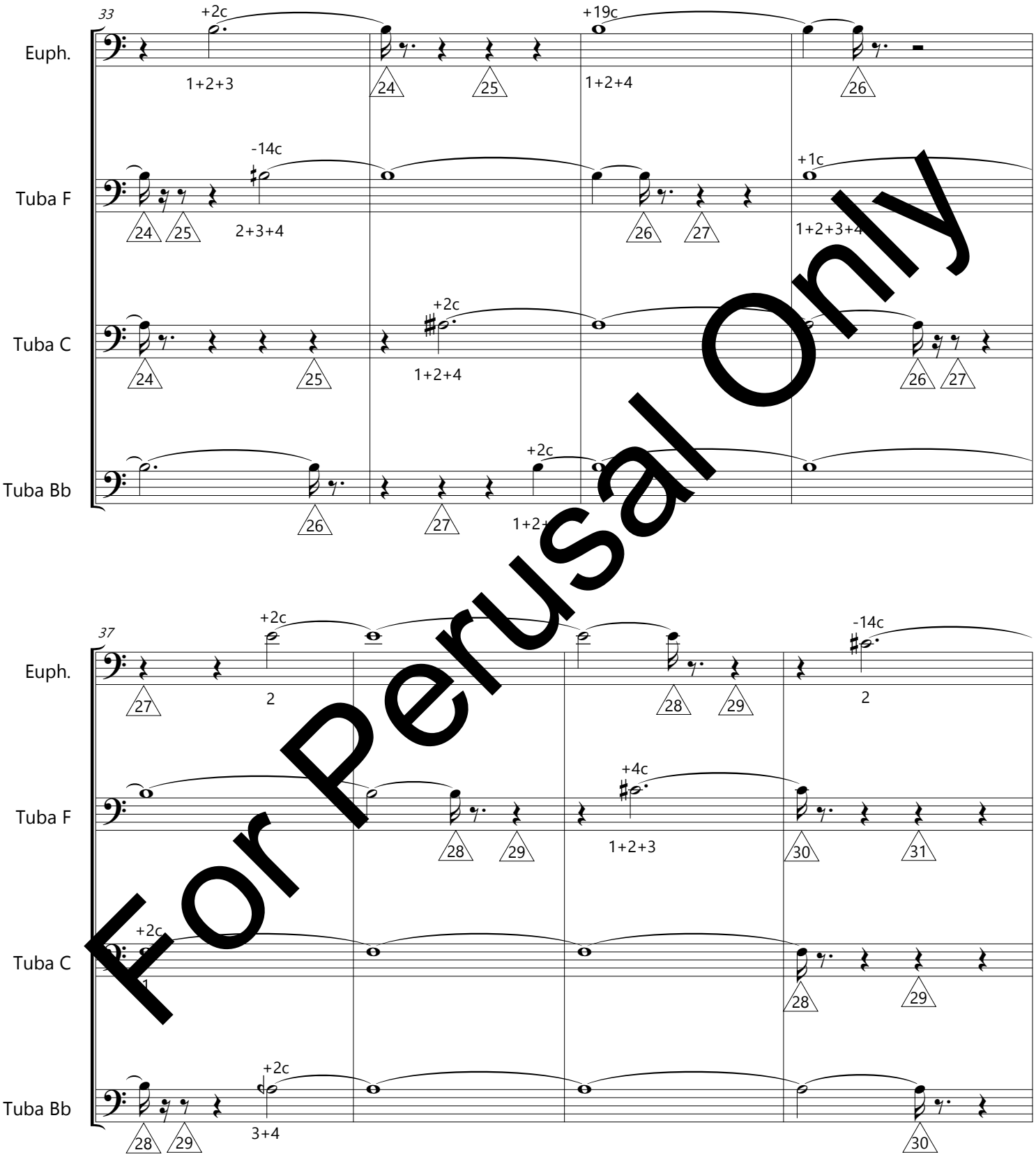

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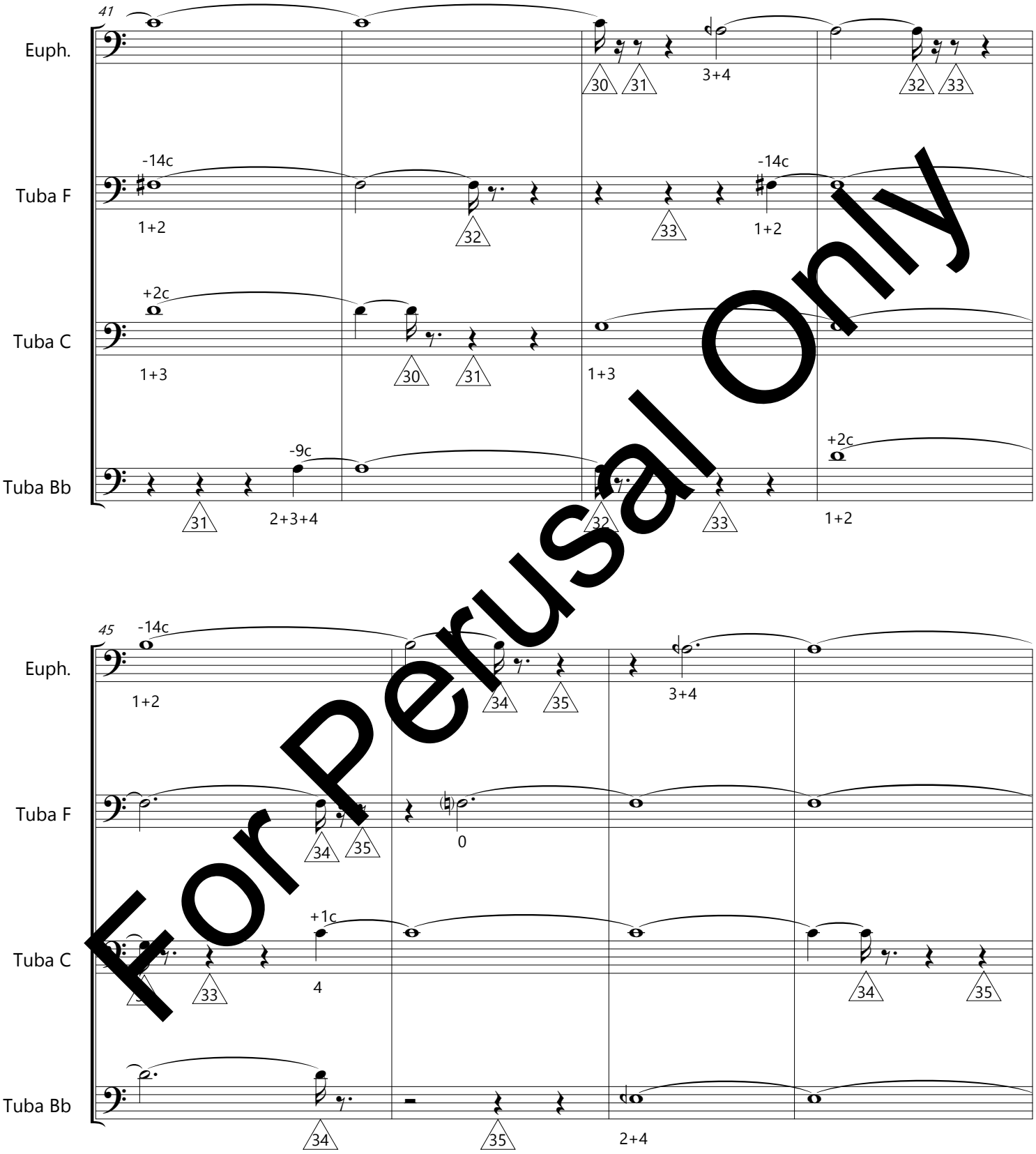

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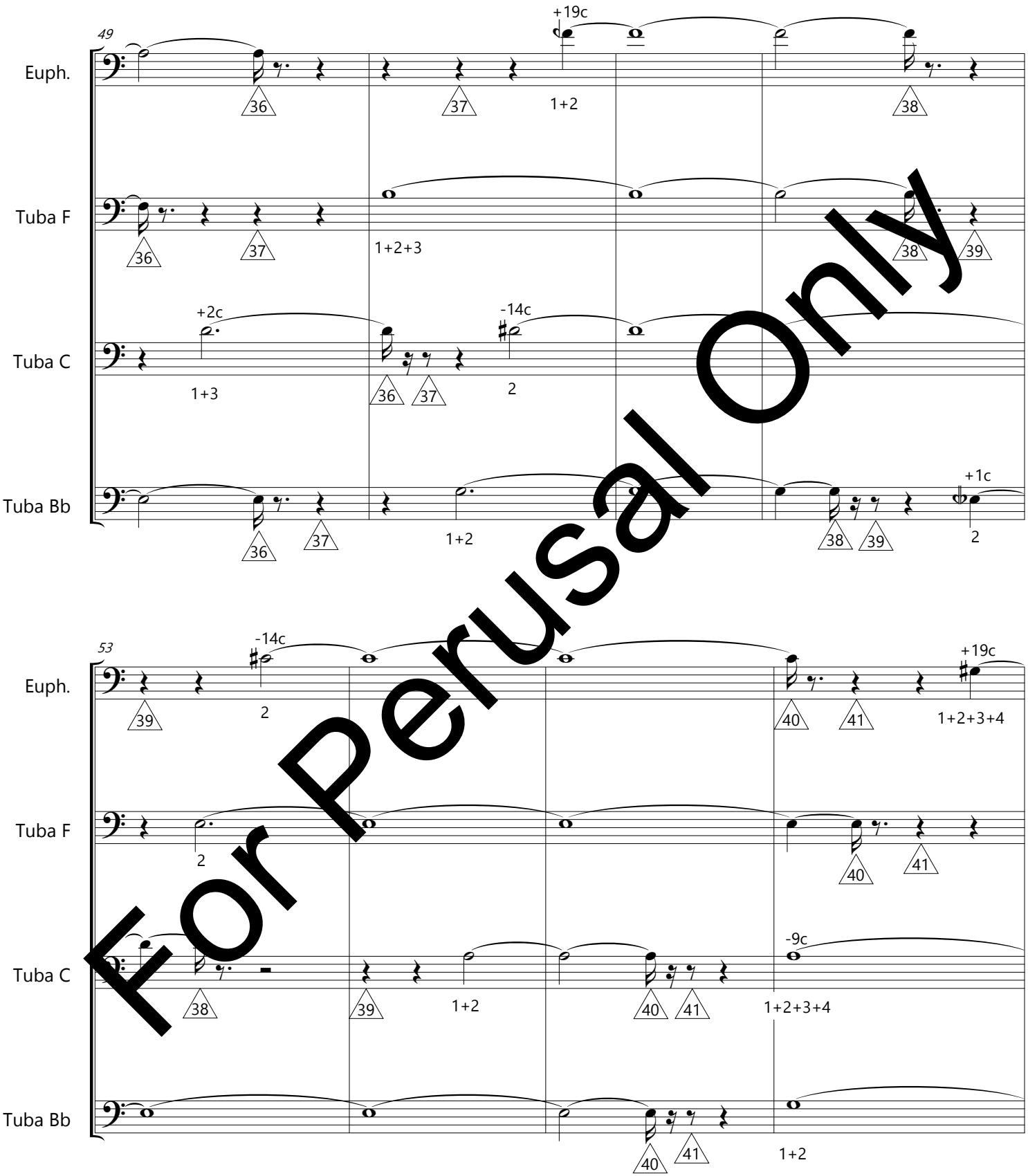

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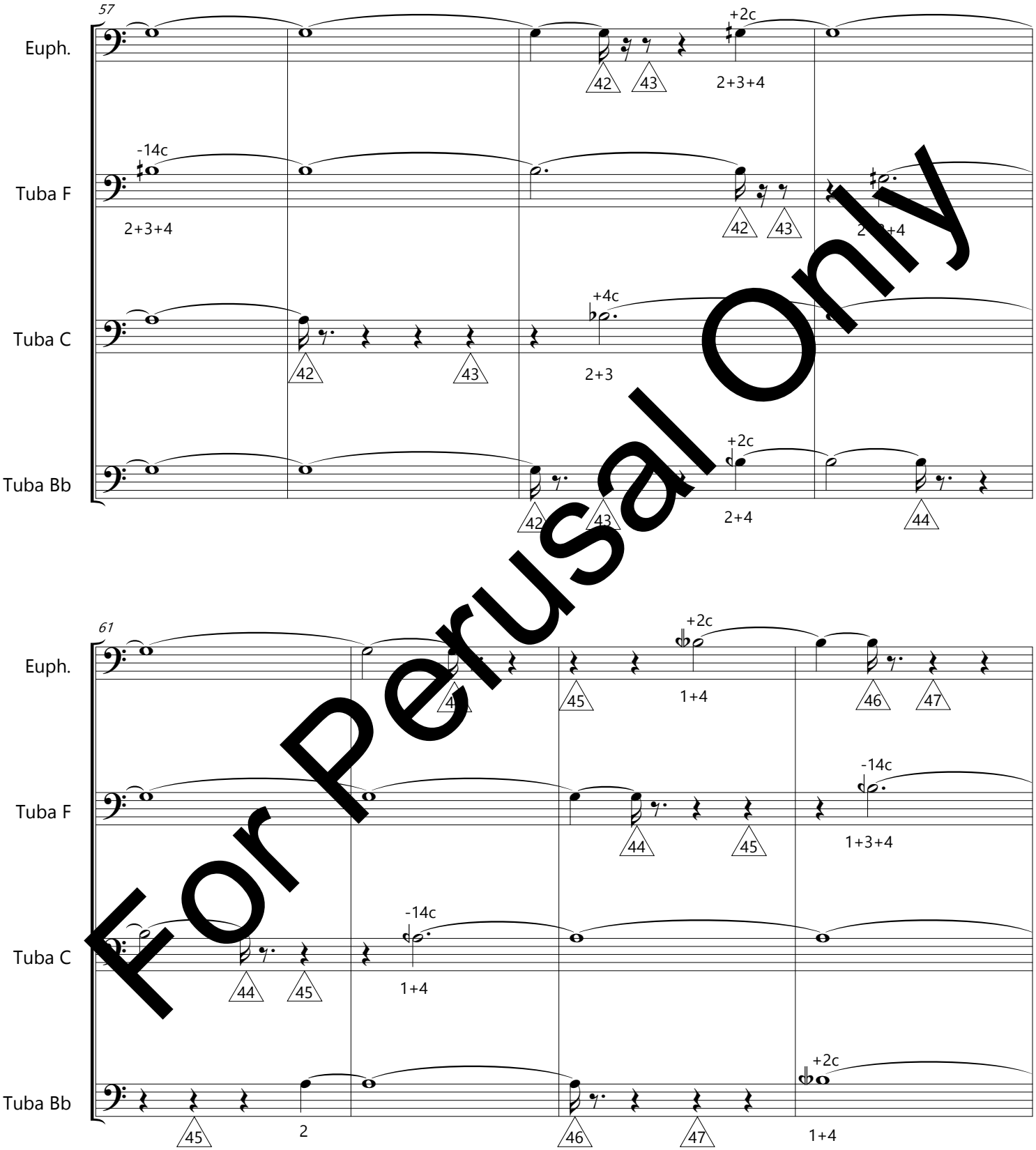

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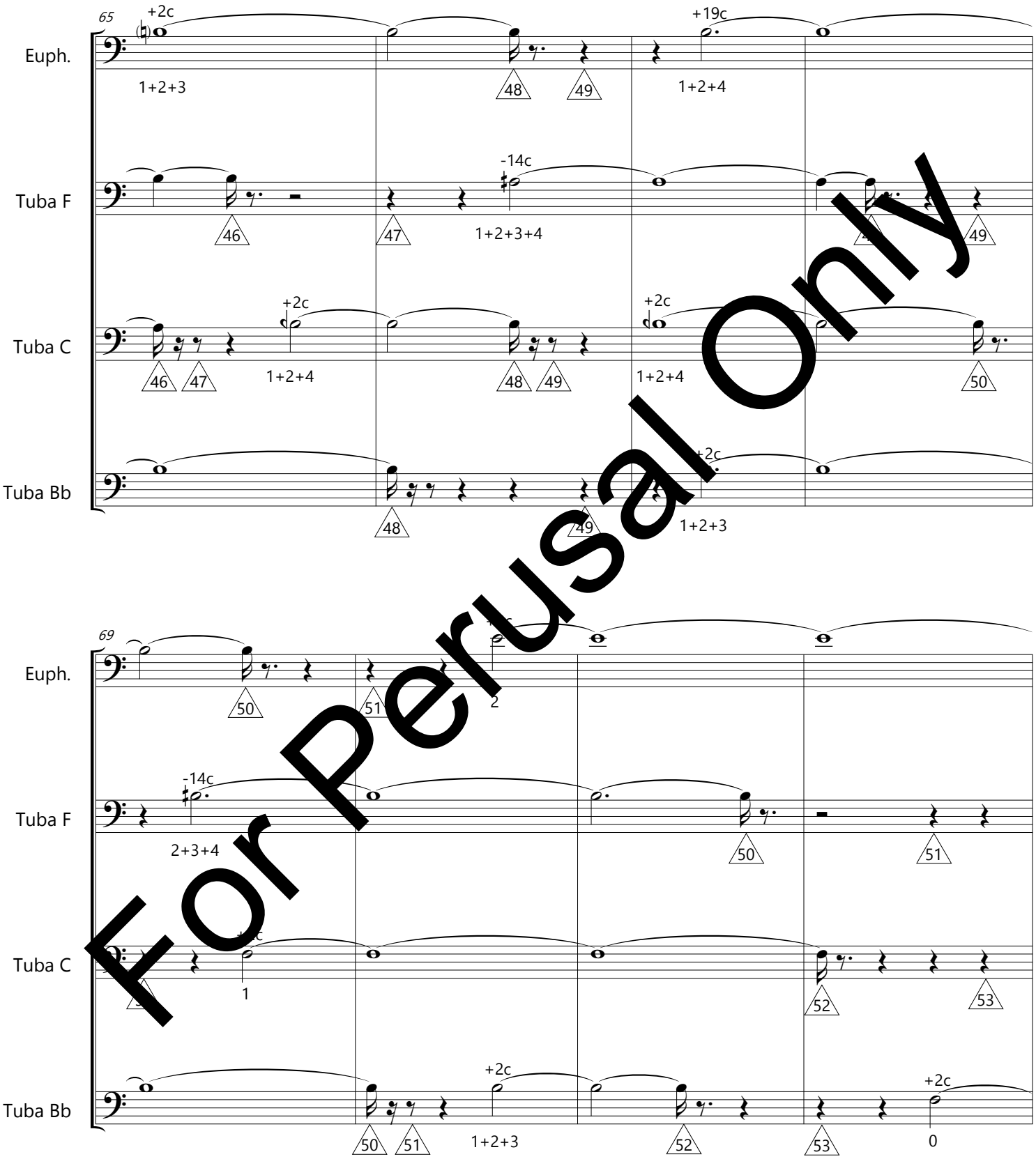

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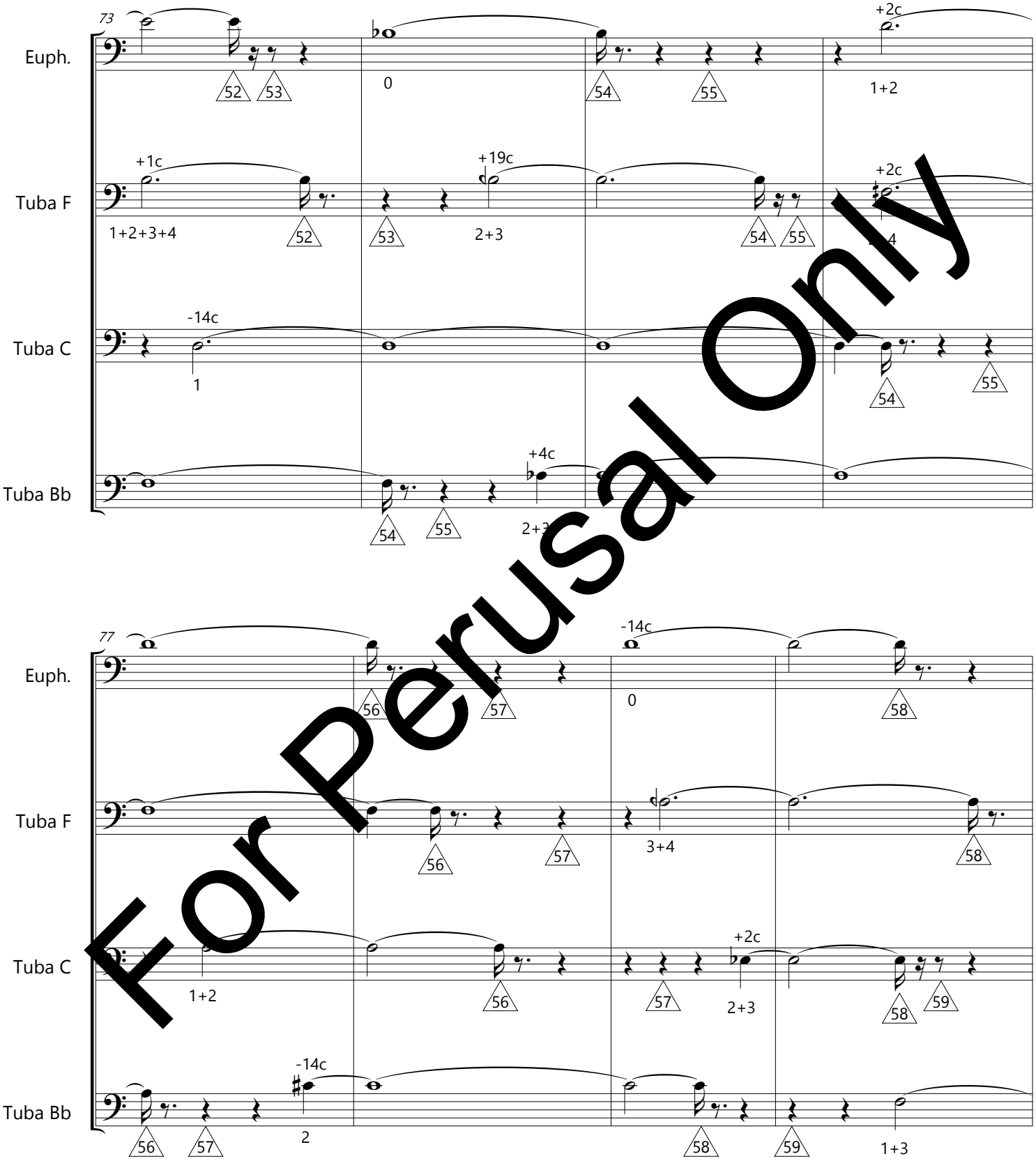

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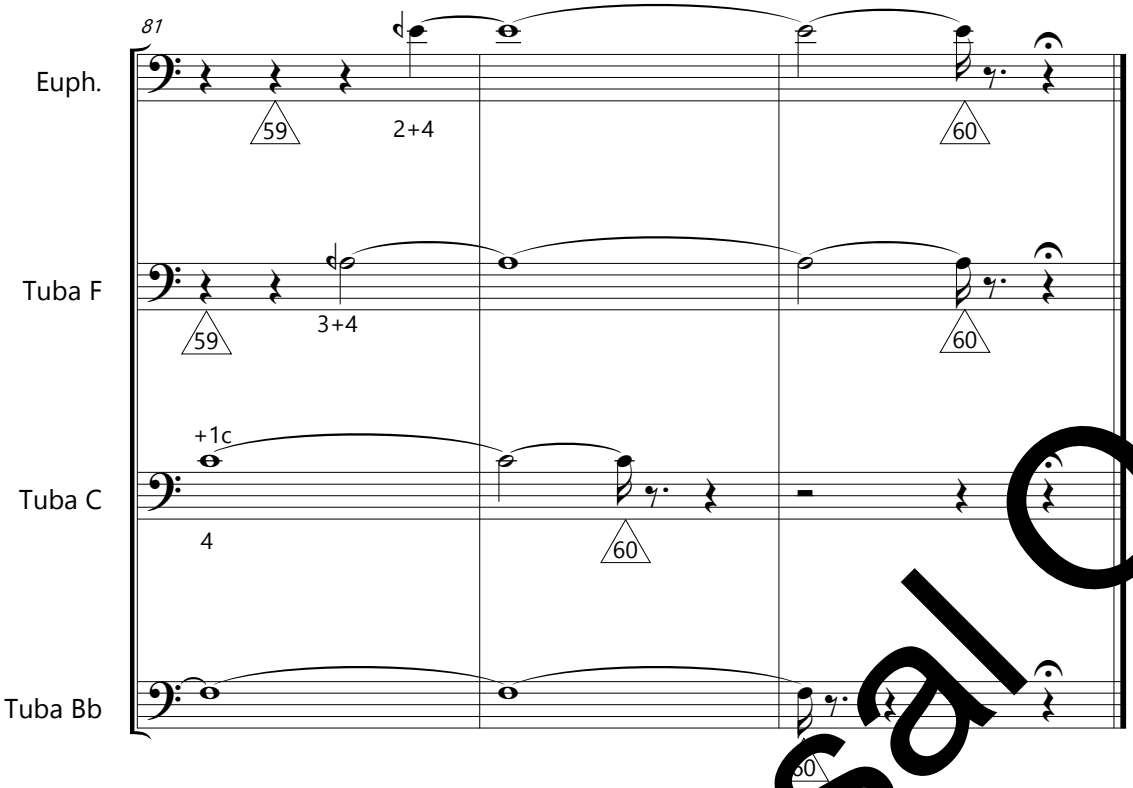

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